

ADHD BUDGET PLANNER

Finally Master Your Money

(Neurodivergent-Friendly)

Simple Systems That Work With Your Brain

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WHY MONEY IS HARD WITH ADHD

You're not bad with money. Your brain works differently:

TIME BLINDNESS:

Future feels abstract. 'Future me' isn't real.

IMPULSIVITY:

See it, want it, buy it. Dopamine seeking.

OUT OF SIGHT:

If you can't SEE the money, it doesn't exist.

OVERWHELM:

Too many accounts/bills = shut down completely.

SHAME SPIRAL:

Avoiding looking at the damage makes it worse.

HYPERFOCUS:

Can spend hours researching a \$20 purchase, forget rent.

This planner uses: VISUAL + SIMPLE + AUTOMATED

THE ADHD MONEY SYSTEM

The 3 Principles:

1. AUTOMATE:

Set up auto-pay for everything possible. No willpower needed.

2. VISUALIZE:

Use cash envelopes or visual trackers. Make money VISIBLE.

3. SIMPLIFY:

5 categories max. Fewer decisions = less overwhelm.

The 3-Account System:

Account 1 - BILLS:

All fixed expenses auto-pay from here. Don't touch it.

Account 2 - SPENDING:

Your weekly 'allowance.' When it's gone, it's gone.

Account 3 - SAVINGS:

Auto-transfer on payday. Out of sight = safe.

INCOME TRACKER (SIMPLIFIED)

Monthly take-home pay: \$ _____

Pay frequency: ☐ Weekly ☐ Bi-weekly ☐ Monthly

Other income: \$ _____ Source: _____

TOTAL MONTHLY INCOME: \$ _____

Split it up:

Bills account (50-60%): \$ _____

Spending account (30-40%): \$ _____

Savings account (10-20%): \$ _____

Auto-transfer date (payday): _____

BILL CALENDAR (VISUAL DUE DATES)

Day	Bill Name	Amount	Auto-pay?	Paid?

TOTAL monthly bills: \$_____

TIP: Set ALL bills to auto-pay. Then forget about them!

WEEKLY SPENDING CHECK-IN - Week 1

Week of: _____ Spending budget this week: \$ _____

ONLY 5 CATEGORIES (keep it simple!):

Category	Budget	Spent	Left	Over?
Food/Groceries	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Transport/Gas	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Fun/Entertainment	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Personal/Self-care	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Other	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐

Total spent: \$ _____ Left in spending account: \$ _____

Impulse purchases this week: _____

Do I need to adjust anything next week? _____

Win: _____

WEEKLY SPENDING CHECK-IN - Week 2

Week of: _____ Spending budget this week: \$ _____

ONLY 5 CATEGORIES (keep it simple!):

Category	Budget	Spent	Left	Over?
Food/Groceries	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Transport/Gas	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Fun/Entertainment	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Personal/Self-care	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Other	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐

Total spent: \$ _____ Left in spending account: \$ _____

Impulse purchases this week: _____

Do I need to adjust anything next week? _____

Win: _____

WEEKLY SPENDING CHECK-IN - Week 3

Week of: _____ Spending budget this week: \$ _____

ONLY 5 CATEGORIES (keep it simple!):

Category	Budget	Spent	Left	Over?
Food/Groceries	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Transport/Gas	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Fun/Entertainment	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Personal/Self-care	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Other	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐

Total spent: \$ _____ Left in spending account: \$ _____

Impulse purchases this week: _____

Do I need to adjust anything next week? _____

Win: _____

WEEKLY SPENDING CHECK-IN - Week 4

Week of: _____ Spending budget this week: \$ _____

ONLY 5 CATEGORIES (keep it simple!):

Category	Budget	Spent	Left	Over?
Food/Groceries	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Transport/Gas	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Fun/Entertainment	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Personal/Self-care	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Other	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐

Total spent: \$ _____ Left in spending account: \$ _____

Impulse purchases this week: _____

Do I need to adjust anything next week? _____

Win: _____

WEEKLY SPENDING CHECK-IN - Week 5

Week of: _____ Spending budget this week: \$ _____

ONLY 5 CATEGORIES (keep it simple!):

Category	Budget	Spent	Left	Over?
Food/Groceries	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Transport/Gas	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Fun/Entertainment	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Personal/Self-care	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Other	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐

Total spent: \$ _____ Left in spending account: \$ _____

Impulse purchases this week: _____

Do I need to adjust anything next week? _____

Win: _____

WEEKLY SPENDING CHECK-IN - Week 6

Week of: _____ Spending budget this week: \$ _____

ONLY 5 CATEGORIES (keep it simple!):

Category	Budget	Spent	Left	Over?
Food/Groceries	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Transport/Gas	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Fun/Entertainment	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Personal/Self-care	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Other	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐

Total spent: \$ _____ Left in spending account: \$ _____

Impulse purchases this week: _____

Do I need to adjust anything next week? _____

Win: _____

WEEKLY SPENDING CHECK-IN - Week 7

Week of: _____ Spending budget this week: \$ _____

ONLY 5 CATEGORIES (keep it simple!):

Category	Budget	Spent	Left	Over?
Food/Groceries	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Transport/Gas	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Fun/Entertainment	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Personal/Self-care	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Other	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐

Total spent: \$ _____ Left in spending account: \$ _____

Impulse purchases this week: _____

Do I need to adjust anything next week? _____

Win: _____

WEEKLY SPENDING CHECK-IN - Week 8

Week of: _____ Spending budget this week: \$ _____

ONLY 5 CATEGORIES (keep it simple!):

Category	Budget	Spent	Left	Over?
Food/Groceries	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Transport/Gas	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Fun/Entertainment	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Personal/Self-care	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Other	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐

Total spent: \$ _____ Left in spending account: \$ _____

Impulse purchases this week: _____

Do I need to adjust anything next week? _____

Win: _____

WEEKLY SPENDING CHECK-IN - Week 9

Week of: _____ Spending budget this week: \$ _____

ONLY 5 CATEGORIES (keep it simple!):

Category	Budget	Spent	Left	Over?
Food/Groceries	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Transport/Gas	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Fun/Entertainment	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Personal/Self-care	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Other	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐

Total spent: \$ _____ Left in spending account: \$ _____

Impulse purchases this week: _____

Do I need to adjust anything next week? _____

Win: _____

WEEKLY SPENDING CHECK-IN - Week 10

Week of: _____ Spending budget this week: \$ _____

ONLY 5 CATEGORIES (keep it simple!):

Category	Budget	Spent	Left	Over?
Food/Groceries	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Transport/Gas	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Fun/Entertainment	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Personal/Self-care	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Other	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐

Total spent: \$ _____ Left in spending account: \$ _____

Impulse purchases this week: _____

Do I need to adjust anything next week? _____

Win: _____

WEEKLY SPENDING CHECK-IN - Week 11

Week of: _____ Spending budget this week: \$ _____

ONLY 5 CATEGORIES (keep it simple!):

Category	Budget	Spent	Left	Over?
Food/Groceries	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Transport/Gas	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Fun/Entertainment	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Personal/Self-care	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Other	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐

Total spent: \$ _____ Left in spending account: \$ _____

Impulse purchases this week: _____

Do I need to adjust anything next week? _____

Win: _____

WEEKLY SPENDING CHECK-IN - Week 12

Week of: _____ Spending budget this week: \$ _____

ONLY 5 CATEGORIES (keep it simple!):

Category	Budget	Spent	Left	Over?
Food/Groceries	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Transport/Gas	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Fun/Entertainment	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Personal/Self-care	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐
Other	\$ _____	\$ _____	\$ _____	☐

Total spent: \$ _____ Left in spending account: \$ _____

Impulse purchases this week: _____

Do I need to adjust anything next week? _____

Win: _____

IMPULSE PURCHASE PAUSE (1/5)

Item #1:

What I want: _____ Cost: \$ _____

Date I first wanted it: _____

WAIT 48 HOURS. Then answer:

Do I still want it? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Meh

Can I actually afford it (not just 'have the money')? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Will I still care about this in 30 days? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Is there something I need MORE? _____

Decision: ☐ Buy it ☐ Skip it ☐ Save for it

Item #2:

What I want: _____ Cost: \$ _____

Date I first wanted it: _____

WAIT 48 HOURS. Then answer:

Do I still want it? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Meh

Can I actually afford it (not just 'have the money')? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Will I still care about this in 30 days? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Is there something I need MORE? _____

Decision: ☐ Buy it ☐ Skip it ☐ Save for it

IMPULSE PURCHASE PAUSE (2/5)

Item #3:

What I want: _____ Cost: \$ _____

Date I first wanted it: _____

WAIT 48 HOURS. Then answer:

Do I still want it? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Meh

Can I actually afford it (not just 'have the money')? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Will I still care about this in 30 days? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Is there something I need MORE? _____

Decision: ☐ Buy it ☐ Skip it ☐ Save for it

Item #4:

What I want: _____ Cost: \$ _____

Date I first wanted it: _____

WAIT 48 HOURS. Then answer:

Do I still want it? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Meh

Can I actually afford it (not just 'have the money')? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Will I still care about this in 30 days? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Is there something I need MORE? _____

Decision: ☐ Buy it ☐ Skip it ☐ Save for it

IMPULSE PURCHASE PAUSE (3/5)

Item #5:

What I want: _____ Cost: \$ _____

Date I first wanted it: _____

WAIT 48 HOURS. Then answer:

Do I still want it? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Meh

Can I actually afford it (not just 'have the money')? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Will I still care about this in 30 days? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Is there something I need MORE? _____

Decision: ☐ Buy it ☐ Skip it ☐ Save for it

Item #6:

What I want: _____ Cost: \$ _____

Date I first wanted it: _____

WAIT 48 HOURS. Then answer:

Do I still want it? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Meh

Can I actually afford it (not just 'have the money')? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Will I still care about this in 30 days? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Is there something I need MORE? _____

Decision: ☐ Buy it ☐ Skip it ☐ Save for it

IMPULSE PURCHASE PAUSE (4/5)

Item #7:

What I want: _____ Cost: \$ _____

Date I first wanted it: _____

WAIT 48 HOURS. Then answer:

Do I still want it? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Meh

Can I actually afford it (not just 'have the money')? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Will I still care about this in 30 days? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Is there something I need MORE? _____

Decision: ☐ Buy it ☐ Skip it ☐ Save for it

Item #8:

What I want: _____ Cost: \$ _____

Date I first wanted it: _____

WAIT 48 HOURS. Then answer:

Do I still want it? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Meh

Can I actually afford it (not just 'have the money')? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Will I still care about this in 30 days? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Is there something I need MORE? _____

Decision: ☐ Buy it ☐ Skip it ☐ Save for it

IMPULSE PURCHASE PAUSE (5/5)

Item #9:

What I want: _____ Cost: \$ _____

Date I first wanted it: _____

WAIT 48 HOURS. Then answer:

Do I still want it? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Meh

Can I actually afford it (not just 'have the money')? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Will I still care about this in 30 days? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Is there something I need MORE? _____

Decision: ☐ Buy it ☐ Skip it ☐ Save for it

Item #10:

What I want: _____ Cost: \$ _____

Date I first wanted it: _____

WAIT 48 HOURS. Then answer:

Do I still want it? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Meh

Can I actually afford it (not just 'have the money')? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Will I still care about this in 30 days? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Is there something I need MORE? _____

Decision: ☐ Buy it ☐ Skip it ☐ Save for it

SUBSCRIPTION AUDIT

List EVERY recurring charge. Be honest. Check bank statement.

Subscription	\$/month	Use it?	Keep/Cancel

Total subscriptions: \$_____/month = \$_____/year (!)

Savings from canceling: \$_____/month

SINKING FUNDS VISUAL TRACKER

Save small amounts over time for big expenses:

Holiday gifts: Goal \$ _____ Have \$ _____

Car maintenance: Goal \$ _____ Have \$ _____

Medical/dental: Goal \$ _____ Have \$ _____

Vacation: Goal \$ _____ Have \$ _____

Emergency: Goal \$ _____ Have \$ _____

DEBT SNOWBALL (SIMPLIFIED)

List debts from SMALLEST to LARGEST. Pay minimum on all.
Throw extra at the smallest. When it's paid, roll that payment to next.

Debt	Total Owed	Min Payment	Paid Off!

Total debt: \$_____ Extra I can throw at smallest: \$_____/month

EMERGENCY FUND PROGRESS BAR

Goal: \$1,000 starter emergency fund

Save \$_____ per week/month

Color in each \$50 saved.

\$50	\$100	\$150	\$200	\$250
\$300	\$350	\$400	\$450	\$500
\$550	\$600	\$650	\$700	\$750
\$800	\$850	\$900	\$950	\$1000

Start date: _____ Goal date: _____

Actual completion date: _____ CELEBRATE!

REWARD SYSTEM FOR FINANCIAL WINS

ADHD brains need rewards! Set up treats for hitting money goals:

Stuck to budget for 1 week:

My reward: _____

Paid a bill on time:

My reward: _____

Resisted impulse purchase:

My reward: _____

Saved \$100:

My reward: _____

Paid off a debt:

My reward: _____

Built \$500 emergency fund:

My reward: _____

3 months of consistent budgeting:

My reward: _____

RULE: Rewards should NOT sabotage your financial goals!

Free/cheap reward ideas: picnic, movie night, sleep in, long bath